

Thursday, 1 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 20° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 17° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 15° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The UK believes Iran was involved in the recent incident at RAF Fairford, according to Prime Minister Andy Burnham.

This comes just days after suspects were released on 'the strictest possible bail conditions'. It's a significant development in a story that's been making headlines.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

The Metropolitan Police have handed their Grenfell Tower fire investigation file to the Crown Prosecution Service.

The force is seeking charges against 54 individuals and 20 companies. This is a major step forward in the long-running inquiry into the 2017 tragedy.

JUSTICE · UK
- 3

MI5 is warning that China is funding UK research and then sending that information to Beijing's spies.

British universities are now being urged to cut ties with the China General Technology Research Institute, which is reportedly linked to the Chinese Ministry of State Security.

NATIONAL SECURITY · UK
- 4

The 'one in, one out' migrant scheme between the UK and France has officially been scrapped.

The scheme, which began just over a year ago, has seen around 1,500 people removed to France. It's a significant shift in cross-Channel policy.

IMMIGRATION · UK
- 5

The national inquiry into child sexual abuse is expanding its grooming gangs investigation to include Birmingham and Wales.

Targeted investigations will now be carried out in these areas. This is a crucial expansion of an already vital inquiry.

JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

1

Get ready, music fans! The first tickets for Glastonbury 2027 are about to go on sale.

The iconic festival will be held from June 23rd to 27th at Worthy Farm in Somerset. It's never too early to start planning for the biggest party of the year!

ON AIR – Are you already thinking about who might headline Glastonbury 2027? Any dream acts you'd love to see?

MUSIC · FUTURE

2

Global superstar Celine Dion made a surprise appearance and performance to kick off Paris Fashion Week!

The singer appeared at the end of L'Oreal's annual show, delighting fans and fashionistas alike. It sounds like a truly show-stopping moment.

ON AIR – What's the most surprising celebrity appearance you've ever witnessed, or wished you had?

FASHION · NOW

3

A '£50 million' painting by the legendary artist Turner is going on display in Rome for the very first time.

His early 19th-century masterpiece, 'Rome, from Mount Aventine', will be exhibited in the Italian capital before heading to auction in London in December. A rare chance to see it!

ON AIR – If you could see any famous artwork in person, what would it be and why?

ART · FUTURE

4

Booker Prize nominee Luke Kennard is praising his school teachers after being shortlisted for the prestigious award.

Luke, who grew up in Chard, is nominated for his novel 'Black Bag'. It's lovely to hear him acknowledge the impact of his early education.

ON AIR – Did you have a teacher who really inspired you or helped you discover a passion?

BOOKS · NOW

5

Great news for culture lovers: National museums across the UK are set to remain free for all visitors.

This decision follows discussions about whether charging tourists could help boost museum finances. It means everyone can continue to enjoy our incredible heritage.

ON AIR – Which national museum or gallery is your absolute favourite to visit, and what do you love about it?

CULTURE · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 **Following the guilty verdicts handed down to Manchester City, everyone's asking: what happens next for the club?**

BBC Sport is looking at the key questions, from a potential criminal investigation to the possibility of relegation or even expulsion. It's a huge moment for English football.

ON AIR – Do you think Manchester City should face a points deduction, relegation, or something else entirely?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Esteban Ocon is fighting to save his Formula 1 career after Haas announced they're splitting with the Frenchman.**

Ocon will leave the team at the end of the year, putting his future on the grid in serious doubt. It's a high-stakes situation in the fast lane.

ON AIR – If you were an F1 team principal, which driver would you sign right now and why?
FORMULA 1 · GLOBAL

3 **Novak Djokovic has secured his first win since Wimbledon at the China Open, beating Nuno Borges.**

This marks his return to the court after reaching the Wimbledon semi-finals in July. A strong start back for the tennis legend.

ON AIR – Who do you think will dominate the tennis world in the coming year, beyond the usual suspects?
TENNIS · GLOBAL

4 **Ever wondered how the London Marathon race order is decided? Apparently, it's 'rock, paper, scissors'!**

A game of the classic hand game was used to determine when the elite female and male races will take place next year. A surprisingly casual way to make a big decision!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual way you've ever seen a sporting decision made, or a tie broken?
RUNNING · UK

5 **England international flanker Tom Curry has signed a new two-year contract extension with Sale Sharks.**

This is great news for both Curry and the club, securing his future with the Premiership side. He's a key player for both club and country.

ON AIR – Which rugby player, past or present, do you think has had the biggest impact on the game?
RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Research suggests that 'the delightful art of decorating your garden shed' is bringing unexpected joy to many.**
It's not just for tools anymore! People are turning their sheds into cosy retreats, art studios, or even miniature pubs, creating a lovely personal space right at home.
- 2 A charming trend sees people 'leaving uplifting messages on post-it notes' in public places.**
From library books to cafe tables, these small acts of kindness are designed to bring a little smile to a stranger's day, proving that tiny gestures can have a big impact.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'watching bread rise slowly in the oven'.**
There's something wonderfully satisfying and peaceful about observing the transformation of dough into a golden loaf, a simple pleasure that connects us to traditional home crafts.
- 4 A study found that 'wearing a favourite, slightly worn-out jumper' can significantly boost feelings of comfort and nostalgia.**
It seems that well-loved clothing, imbued with memories, offers a unique sense of security and warmth, proving old favourites are often the best.
- 5 The delightful hobby of 'collecting unusual old keys' is gaining popularity.**
Each key tells a silent story of a lock it once opened, sparking imagination about forgotten doors and secret gardens, making for a fascinating and affordable collection.
- 6 A new report suggests that 'the therapeutic act of arranging books by colour' is becoming a popular organisational trend.**
Beyond just alphabetical order, this visually pleasing method not only tidies shelves but can also create a calming aesthetic in any room.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'observing squirrels in your local park' is being celebrated as a wonderful mood booster.**
Their energetic antics and playful chases provide endless entertainment, reminding us to find joy in the everyday wonders of nature right on our doorstep.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: ...GIVING THE PACKAGING A LITTLE SQUEEZE TO FEEL THE TEXTURE OF THE CHEESE INSIDE!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new podcast, especially if it's a highly anticipated one. What is it?

ANSWER: ...MAKING SURE THEIR LISTENING DEVICE IS ON AN EVEN NUMBER VOLUME SETTING!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit tin' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't seen one in years?

We're talking about those iconic tins that were often filled with buttons or sewing supplies, not biscuits! Which biscuit tin takes you back, and what was actually inside it?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household chore' that, no matter how much we might grumble about it, secretly makes you feel oddly satisfied once it's done, don't we?

Is it putting away the clean laundry, polishing the kitchen tap until it gleams, or perhaps vacuuming those perfect lines into the carpet? What's your secretly satisfying chore?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat? Their diet of brine shrimp and algae contains pigments called carotenoids, which give them their distinctive rosy hue.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that in Switzerland, it's illegal to own just one guinea pig, as they are considered social animals and get lonely without a companion?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'richest' soil on Earth can be found in the Russian chernozem belt, renowned for its deep black colour and fertility.
- A group of ferrets is called a 'business'.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one, and his wish was granted.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's largest known snowflake, recorded in Montana in 1887, was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered one of the toughest tongue twisters in the English language.
- Before erasers, breadcrumbs were used to remove pencil marks.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.

On this day

Day 274 of the year, 91 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (South Korea); Beginning of the United States' Fiscal Year; Children's Day (El Salvador, Guatemala, Sri Lanka); Christian feast day: Abai (Syriac Orthodox Church). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Martin Turner, English singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1962 — Esai Morales, American actor
- 1948 — Cub Koda, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2000)
- 1968 — Kevin Griffin, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 2006 — Priah Ferguson, American actress
- 1987 — Matthew Daddario, American actor
- 1973 — John Mackey, American composer
- 1973 — Christian Borle, American actor and singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2024 — Israel invaded Southern Lebanon, marking the fifth Israeli invasion of Lebanon since 1978.
- 1982 — Helmut Kohl replaces Helmut Schmidt as Chancellor of Germany through a constructive vote of no confidence.
- 2014 — A double bombing of an elementary school in Homs, Syria kills over 50 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2000 — Israeli–Palestinian conflict: Palestinians protest the killing of 12-year-old Muhammad al-Durrah by Israeli police in northern Israel, beginning the "October 2000 events".
- 2001 — 3G wireless technology first becomes available when it is adopted by Japanese telecommunications company NTT Docomo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1987 — The 5.9 Mw Whittier Narrows earthquake shakes the San Gabriel Valley with a Mercalli intensity of VIII (Severe), killing eight and injuring 200.
- 2015 — Heavy rains trigger a major landslide in Guatemala, killing 280 people.

- 2014 — A series of explosions at a gunpowder plant in Bulgaria completely destroys the factory, killing 15 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 275 of the year, 90 days left in 2026. Today Batik Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Blessed Antoine Chevrier; Christian feast day: Denha I of Tikrit (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Jan Beyzym. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Kelly Ripa, American actress and talk show host
- 1960 — Django Bates, English musician and composer
- 1949 — Richard Hell, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1988 — Brittany Howard, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1958 — Robbie Nevil, American singer-songwriter
- 1941 — Diana Hendry, English poet and author
- 1929 — Moses Gunn, American actor (died 1993)
- 1976 — Mark Chilton, English cricketer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2002 — The Beltway sniper attacks begin in Washington, D.C., extending over three weeks and killing 10 people.
- 1970 — An aircraft carrying the Wichita State University football team, administrators, and supporters crashes in Colorado, killing 31 people.
- 2016 — Ethiopian protests break out during a festival in the Oromia region, killing dozens of people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1996 — The Electronic Freedom of Information Act Amendments are signed by U.S. President Bill Clinton.
- 1968 — Mexican President Gustavo Díaz Ordaz orders soldiers to suppress a demonstration of unarmed students, ten days before the start of the 1968 Summer Olympics.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar